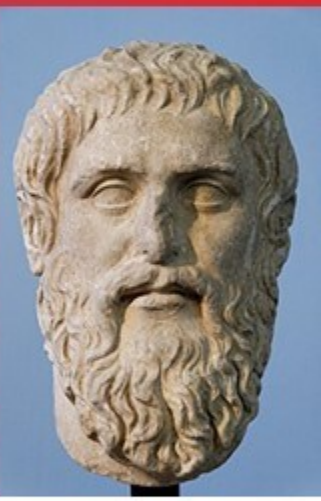
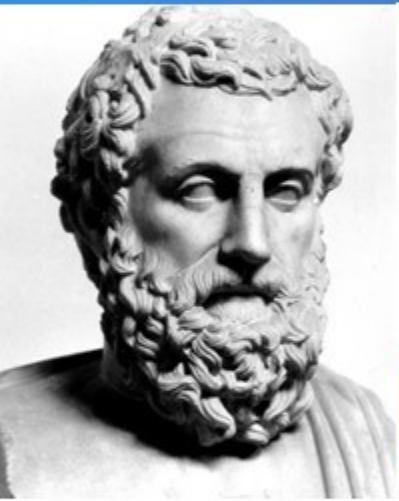


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



ATTITUDE

MODULE – 20

POLITICAL ATTITUDES

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

ATTITUDES OF SUPPORTERS OF TWO DIFFERENT PARTIES



GST



AADHAR

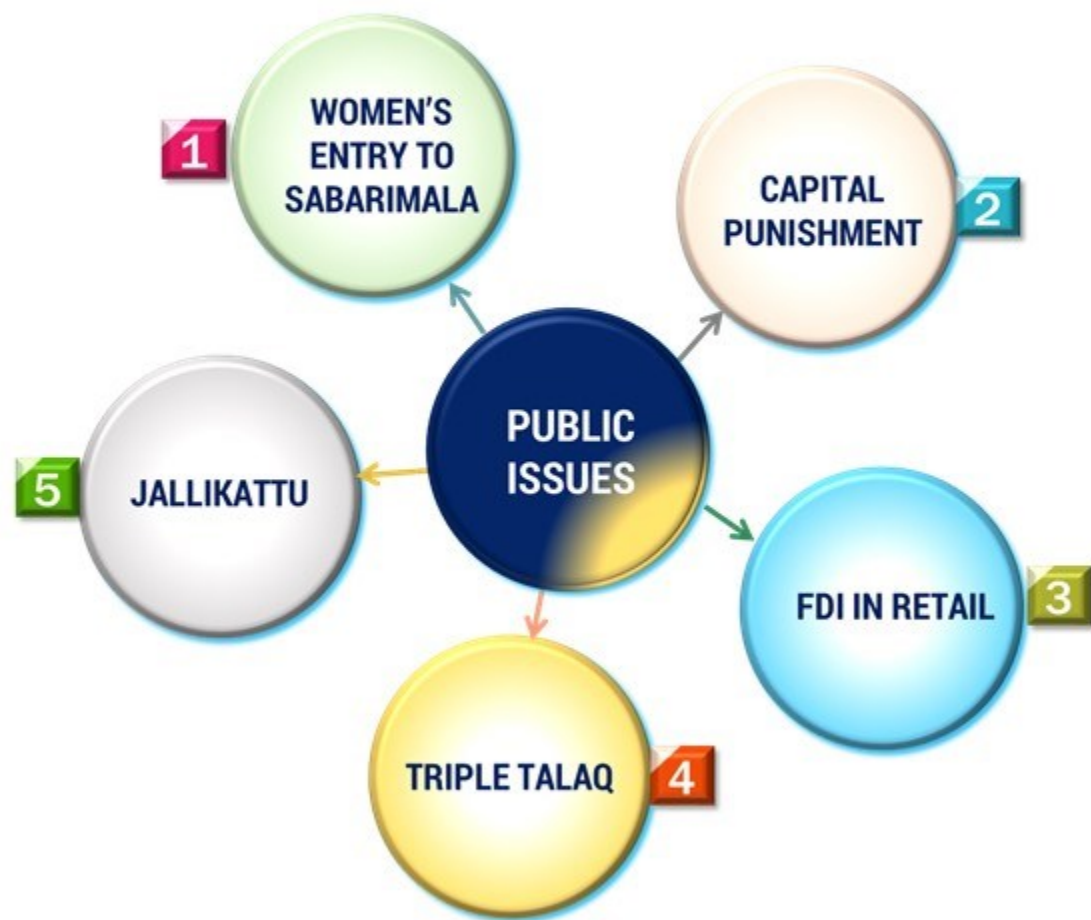


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People look at each of these issues on a standalone basis and through the ideological prism of the political party they are supporter of.

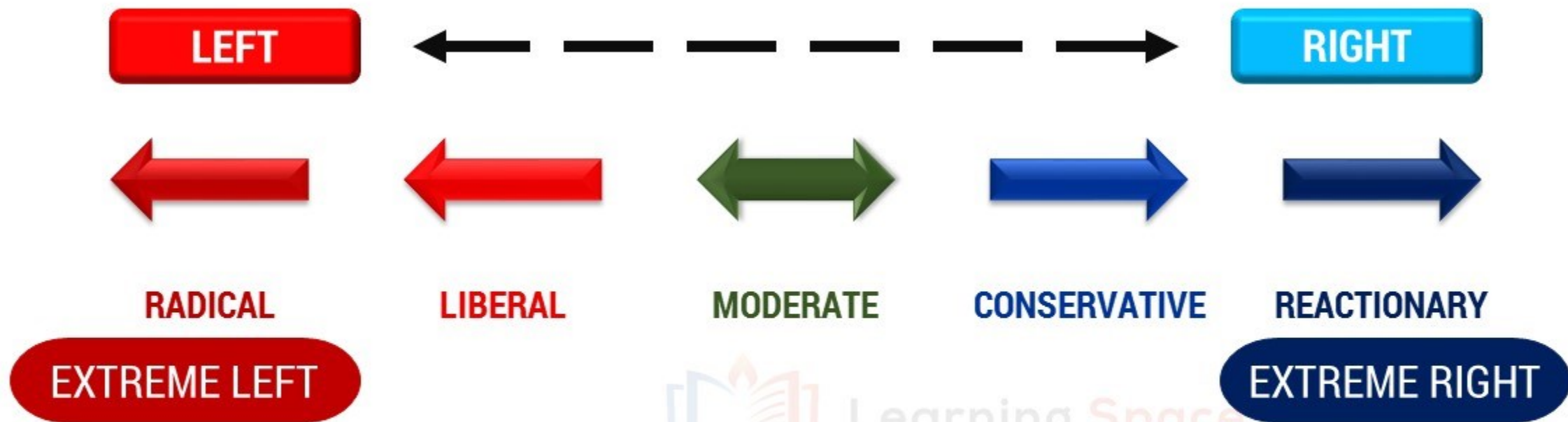
Some people (left leaning) may support 'Women's entry to Sabarimala', be ambivalent to 'Triple Talaq' and oppose the rest of the issues.

Some others (right leaning) may oppose 'Women's entry to Sabarimala' and support everything else listed.

People examine and judge the issues through their political leanings, not just on merits of the issues.

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

THE POLITICAL SPECTRUM

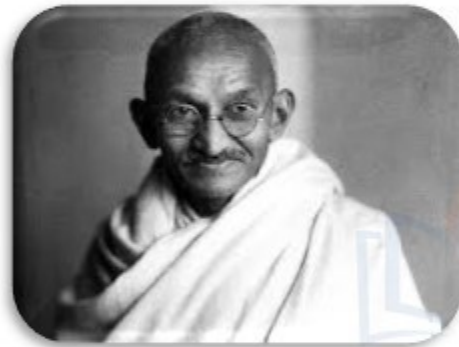


These ideological terms **designate attitudes** which **seek changes** in the existing political setup, and which **uphold certain political values**.

These ideologies **stand for different ideas** in different countries. The **differences** between the ideologies is **more pronounced** in some **countries** than in other countries.

RADICALISM

To understand political attitudes better, we need to first understand the political ideologies.



Radicals protest against the gap between democratic rhetoric and real life realities, challenge complacency, think the unthinkable and induce the society's main stream to mend its ways.

Radicals (individuals, parties or movements) are highly dissatisfied with the society and seek to drastically alter existing practice, institution or social system.

Extreme leftists challenge the prevailing most cherished values and assumptions in a society, reject the institutions of the establishment and seek a more humane, idealistic and egalitarian system.

Radicals need not always be violent: Pacifists, who totally reject violence such as Mahatma Gandhi, can also be radicals.

Many people in the society share the ideals, may be passively, but lack the idealism and suffer from inertia to fight for the change.

LIBERALISM

*It is the **liberals** who **pioneered** social, economic and political **reforms** in USA and Europe, including in UK.*



Classical liberalism: based on negative freedom

Modern liberalism: based on positive freedom

Liberals, while subscribing to the core values of the society and upholding the laws, are **open to reform** for correcting the defects of the society.

Liberals believe that **government** is **necessary** to protect individual rights, but **fear** that government **can also threaten individual liberty** by usurping rights. Liberals advocate protecting and increasing individual freedom.

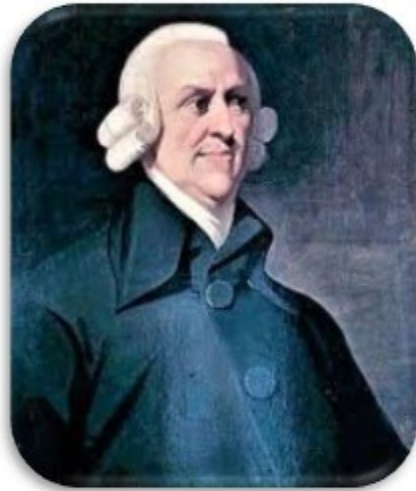
There are **two types** of liberalism:

- a) **Classical** – government should protect individual liberty.
- b) **Modern** – government should increase individual freedom by promoting conditions.

Classical liberals championed free trade and markets, and believed that it leads to public good.



JOHN LOCKE



ADAM SMITH

The three individual rights are: freedom to speak and write freely, freedom to associate and organise and freedom from fear of reprisal.

Early liberals aimed to free individuals from the constraints of religious conformity and aristocratic privileges.

They wanted government to be accountable to people and argued for a government elected by the majority, paving the way for democracy.

They advocated power resting with property owners and elite, creation of individual rights and separation of the three wings: legislature, executive and judiciary.

Even though they wanted to limit the government's role, they conceded that the government must provide public services such as education, sanitation and a law system.

The unequal wealth distribution from industrial revolution and the resulting control of the government by the rich gave birth to **modern liberalism**.

The ideology propounds that **government should establish** educational institutions and hospitals, **aid** the poor and **regulate** working conditions to **promote** workers' welfare.



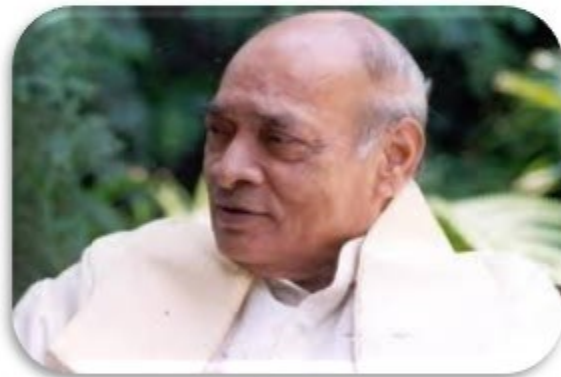
Although the rise of fascist dictatorships and communism after WW I shattered liberal illusions, **more government intervention** resulted in unprecedented growth in western countries.

Modern liberals **support** market economy **but** want to modify and control the system for greater good rather than abolish it.



J M KEYNES

- Limited intervention in the market
- Greater equality to wealth and income



Right to freedom of speech, respect the volition of the adults in their choices of life etc., resulted in public debates on censorship and homosexuality.

Decline in economic growth, stagnation, and high costs of social welfare in the western countries in the 1970s lead to **revival of classical liberalism**.

This resulted in **support for** the ideal of markets and limiting the role of the government (very similar to conservative arguments).

Liberalism aims at extending individual rights, foster plurality of different ways of life by protecting the rights of the middle class, religious minorities, working class and the poor and racial minorities.

MODERATES



Lying at the middle of the political spectrum, moderates **combine** democracy and individual freedom from capitalism, and collective ownership and planning from communism.

Moderates are not as **enthusiastic to change** as radicals or liberals but more enthusiastic than conservatives.

Moderates **oppose harsh and rigid versions of the doctrines** and implementing policies in violation of human rights and considerations, and they are more humane.

Because of taking a middle ground on most issues, moderates are **often derided** by their more ideologically inclined colleagues in the respective parties.

CONSERVATISM

*Conservatism is not just an ideology, it is **also human temperament**.*



EDMOND BURKE

Unlike liberals, conservatives argue that efforts to plan a society using abstract principles are misguided and end in disaster.

Conservatism emphasizes the value of traditional practices and institutions and favours institutions that evolve slowly, not through violent and disruptive methods.

Conservatives deny human perfectibility and believe that humans can be morally improved through social and political change.

They believe that humans are driven by passion and desires, and are naturally selfish, disorderly, irrational and violent.

On the other hand, they trust unbroken historical continuity and believe that human affairs should be conducted within traditional structures – political, religious or cultural.

*Their outlook favours **restoration** of a previous, often outmoded, political or social order.*



JOSEPH DE MAISTRE

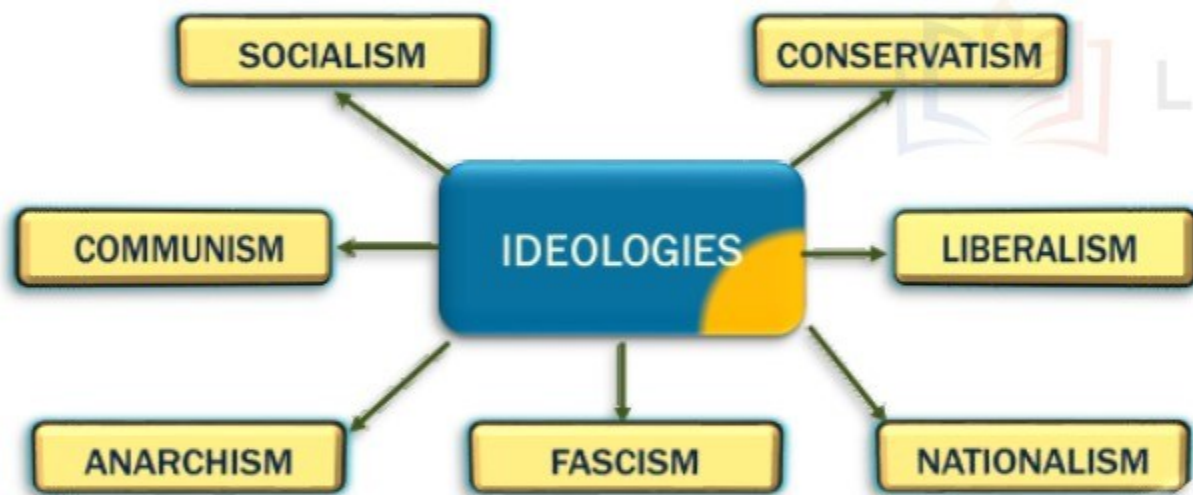
Reactionaries seem to **fight** a rearguard action **against** advancing, dynamic forces propelling new classes to power.

Their ideology is **shaped because** usually they are **beneficiaries of the old order** and **cannot digest the changes**.

Zamindars and jagirdars opposing the abolition of their privileges, a few rulers resisting the integration of native states into India, and the monarchial groups, aristocracy and church who lost power after World War I are examples of reactionaries.

In India, **extremist right wing groups** are reactionary in nature and hanker after the past glory, real or imaginary.

Political ideology is a form of political or social philosophy which combines thought (theory) and action (practice).



Socialism is widely practised in India, even after the economic reforms initiated by the P V Narasimha Rao government in 1991.

Communism: Propounded by Karl Marx and meaning a shared or common vision of the society, this political and economic doctrine seeks to replace private property and a profit based economy with public ownership and control of the means of production and natural resources.

Socialism: Advocates policies that meet the basic needs of the entire society, not just the elite. Social democrats, unlike communists, believe in integrating socialism and democracy.

Anarchism: The most influential form of non-Marxist communism, anarchism advocates not only communal ownership of the property but also the abolition of the government.

*Although **fascism is dangerous**, dubbing one's opponents as fascists, at the smallest altercation, is deplorable.*



Fascism: This authoritarian ideology claims itself to be an **elitist response** to modern political and social problems which other ideologies cannot resolve. As can be seen from Hitler and Mussolini's rule, fascism **advocates complete surrender to the state.**

Nationalism: It is a political, social, and economic ideology and movement **characterized by the promotion of the interests of a particular nation** with the aim of gaining and maintaining the nation's sovereignty (self-governance) over its homeland

Nationalism is a modern concept and it can result in either good or bad outcomes depending on the situation.

FACTORS SHAPING POLITICAL ATTITUDES

Several factors play a role in shaping the political attitudes of the people.



Family: Despite family disagreements and generation gaps, children tend to grow up and vote the way their parents do. Families are generally the first, and often the most enduring, influence on young people's developing political opinions.

Values: Personal values predispose people towards certain ideologies.

Example: liberals support homosexuality because they value individual rights whereas conservatives oppose it because they value family and traditions.

Age: The young are more receptive to change than the old and hence they tend to be liberal. Young people may have weaker sense of commitment and belonging.

FACTORS SHAPING POLITICAL ATTITUDES

Gender, religion, caste, region, education, traditional media/social media, and race or ethnicity also affect our political attitudes.



The education in totalitarian or communist countries tends to brain wash the subjects into believing in the virtues of the political and economic systems under practice in those countries.

Personality Traits: Our psychological traits are shaped by family, education, culture and work. **Extroversion, agreeableness, conscientiousness, emotional stability and openness to experience** are the traits that affect political attitudes.

Psychological reasons: If someone is a liberal, he/she must be **tolerant to disorder**. Whereas a conservative person is not **tolerant to change**.

Economic factors: One's **class position and class interest** determine one's political attitudes. A well-paid worker may lean towards capitalism than towards socialism. Political attitudes of middle class tend to be different from those of poor people.

PROBLEMS OF AN IDEOLOGICAL APPROACH

*Having strong ideological inclinations causes some **problems**, as can be seen in our society.*



1 Ideology makes one **have pre-determined responses** to many issues. Leftists or liberals approve of shouting anti-national slogans and foreign agencies reporting on human rights abuses in India, and they disapprove of military actions against terrorists and Naxalites.

2 Idealistic **students are vulnerable** and tend to gravitate towards the ideology of Marxism/communism because of the egalitarian principles, but ignore the drawbacks of the ideology.

3 People strongly attracted to two different ideologies tend to **form separate groups** and **view the others as enemies**, which may result in violence.

PROBLEMS OF AN IDEOLOGICAL APPROACH



4 Academics, blinded by their ideological leanings, lose their objectivity and neutrality and end up blindly supporting one political disposition.

5 Ideological obsessions enable malicious groups to exploit the vulnerability of the supporters, especially students, for their own ulterior motives.

Example: The strife seen across Indian Universities, and the political parties pushing their agenda under the guise of ideology.

6 Depending solely on the ideology forces hasty application of these theories to social issues without paying enough attention to the practicalities.

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